

1.2.4 The Waterfall Model

وائرفال (آبشار) ماڈل ایک سیدھا اور ترتیب وار طریقہ ہے؛ ہر مرحلہ مکمل ہونے کے بعد ہی اگلا شروع ہوتا ہے اور پیچھے جانا مشکل ہوتا ہے۔

CS XI

Chapter 1: Computer Systems

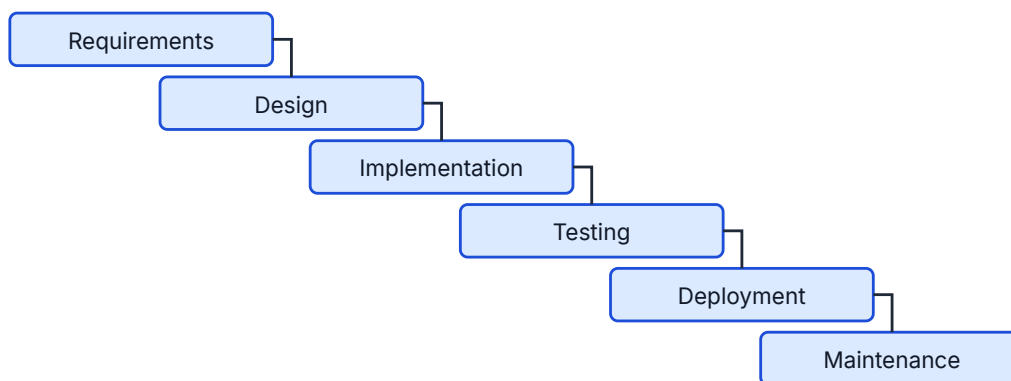
Lecture 16 of 20

★ Golden

1.2.4 The Waterfall Model ★ Golden

LEARN IT

The **Waterfall model** is a **linear, sequential** approach to the SDLC. Each phase must be completed before the next one begins, like water falling down steps. There is no easy way to go back to a previous phase.



The Waterfall model: each phase "falls" into the next, in one direction only.

When to use it

- Requirements are clear, fixed and well understood.
- The project is small to medium in size.
- The technology is stable (not new or experimental).

Advantages (Pros)	Disadvantages (Cons)
Simple to understand and manage.	Not flexible to changes.
Well documented at every step.	Testing happens very late in the process.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Case study: Al-Noor Library Management System. The textbook uses this system as a Waterfall case study because the requirements were **100% fixed before coding began**.

Step 1: The librarian listed exactly what was needed: add books, issue books, return books, calculate fines. Nothing would change.

Step 2: Because the list was fixed, the team could finish the full design, then all the coding, then all the testing, in order.

Step 3: Every phase produced a document, so the library has a complete record for future maintenance.

REMEMBER IT

Waterfall = water only flows downwards. Once water has fallen it cannot climb back up — once a phase is finished you do not go back.

COMMON MISTAKE

Do not choose Waterfall for a project where the customer is still unsure what they want. A late change means going back through design, coding and testing, which is slow and costly.

اردو میں سمجھیں

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EXAM TIP

Expect "Explain the Waterfall model with its advantages and disadvantages" or "When should the Waterfall model be used?" Draw the step diagram, list the three "when to use" conditions, and give at least two pros and two cons. Mention the Al-Noor Library case study as your example.

CHECK YOURSELF

1. Why is the Waterfall model called "sequential"?
2. Why did the Al-Noor Library system use Waterfall?

Answers: 1. Because each phase must be completed before the next begins, in a fixed order. 2. Because its requirements were 100% fixed before coding began.

Next lecture: 1.2.4 The Agile Model